

E4 SPECIAL CHARACTER AREAS

Local character is what makes one area distinctive from another. It is the way an area ‘looks’ and ‘feels’. Character is created through the interrelation of distinctive natural and built elements in the public and private domains, including topography, vegetation, streetscape, built form, activity types, as well as the emotional and cultural experience of a place. All areas in the Waverley local government area (LGA) have character, however in some, the character may be more identifiable, more unusual, or more attractive and what is important in one area might be different in another – from vibrant local centres, leafy streets, consistent dwelling typologies and architectural styles to areas and items of heritage significance, and access to coastal views and open space.

Special Character Areas are areas in the Waverley LGA which are considered to have a unique and high character value that warrant more tailored planning objectives and controls to ensure that their character is particularly protected and enhanced. Special Character Areas are selected on cultural, scenic or aesthetic grounds.

4.1 BONDI HEIGHTS

Bondi Heights Special Character Area applies to the area bound by Old South Head Road and Francis Street to the north, Wellington Street to the east, Bondi Road to the south and Flood Lane to the west (refer to Figure 1).



Figure 1 Bondi Heights Special Character Area

Existing Character Elements

Bondi Heights Special Character Area is located on a local topographical high point. This vantage allows district views to and from the area. It is characterised by north-south oriented streets with well-established street trees. Street blocks are generally long (700-750m) with a range of site lot sizes. A range of building types and styles exist that relate to lot sizes and development history of the area. The overall character of the area is of buildings that multiunit buildings sit in a landscape setting.

Desired Future Character Objectives

- (a) To ensure the landscape character is the dominant image of Bondi Heights.